# FINAL REPORT REQUIREMENTS

The Final Report is the culmination of your team's work in the competition. It should evaluate how effectively your team implemented its investment strategy, applied it to Laura's financial goals, and developed its final recommendations. The report should draw on your prior deliverables, final WInS portfolio, and analysis without repeating the content of your Investment Policy Statement (IPS) or Trading Notes Analysis.

There is no single correct strategy or recommendation. Teams may reach different conclusions about portfolio construction, risk, funding certainty, the operating reserve, the facility contribution, and financial flexibility. Your report will be evaluated based on the quality of your analysis, evidence, assumptions, judgment, and communication.

## How the Deliverables Fit Together

Each deliverable serves a distinct purpose, but evaluators will consider all three together.

| Deliverable | Purpose |
|---|---|
| **Trading Notes Analysis** | Demonstrate how selected investment decisions reflected your team's strategy during the trading period. |
| **Investment Policy Statement** | Establish your team's investment strategy and decision-making framework. |
| **Final Report** | Evaluate how effectively your team implemented its strategy and present recommendations for Laura. |

The strategy established in your IPS should remain consistent in the Final Report. The Final Report is not an opportunity to create a new strategy or revise the IPS. Evaluators will assess whether your Trading Notes Analysis, final WInS portfolio, assumptions, analysis, and recommendations align with your strategy and Laura's financial goals.

## Minimum Requirements

Your Final Report must:

- Include all required sections.
- Meet the minimum and maximum page requirements.
- Actual holdings.
- Use only permitted investments.
- Address Laura's financial goals and circumstances.
- Demonstrate consistency with the strategy established in the IPS.
- Follow all formatting, citation, and submission requirements.

Reports that do not meet these minimum requirements may be removed from semifinal consideration.

Meeting the minimum requirements makes a report eligible for evaluation. It does not guarantee a strong evaluation.

## Permitted Investments

For all long-term portfolio modeling, teams may use only the following investment types:

- Stocks available on WInS
- Exchange-traded funds available on WInS
- Government or Treasury bonds available on WInS

The following are not permitted:

- Margin trading
- Short selling
- Stock-secured debt
- Cryptocurrency
- Derivatives, including options, futures, and swaps
- Individual TIPS
- Individual STRIPS
- Any investment other than the permitted investments listed above

## Required Format and Submission

- Submit the report through SurveyMonkey Apply by the stated deadline.
- Submit the report as a **PDF file** no larger than 5 MB.
- Use 12-point Times New Roman font.
- Double-space the report.
- Use 1-inch margins.
- Include page numbers in the bottom-left corner.
- Cite **all** sources, images, media, and generative AI use in APA format.
- Include a separate References page.
- Do not include external links that evaluators are expected to open.

Tables and graphics may be single-spaced when needed for readability. Graphics should support the narrative and clarify the team's analysis rather than distract from it.

## Required Report Length

| Section | Minimum | Maximum |
|---|---|---|
| Title Page | 1 page | 1 page |
| Portfolio Implementation | 2 pages | 3 pages |
| Integrated Recommendation and Reflection | 6 pages | 8 pages |
| Total, excluding References | **9 pages** | **12 pages** |

## Section 1: Title Page

**Minimum:** One page

**Maximum:** One page

Include:

- Official team name
- Finalized team member names
- Advisor's first and last name
- Team WInS username

The information must match your official team roster.

## Section 2: Portfolio Implementation

**Minimum:** Two pages

**Maximum:** Three pages

Present your final WInS portfolio and evaluate how effectively it implemented the investment strategy established in your IPS. Explain how the portfolio's construction, allocation, diversification, and most important holdings reflect your strategy and support Laura's financial goals.

Include a table listing every holding in your final WInS portfolio. The table must include each investment's ticker or identifier, name, asset type, amount allocated, and percentage of the portfolio.

**Example Portfolio Table**

*For illustrative purposes only. The holdings and allocations below are not intended to represent a recommended investment strategy.*

| Ticker | Name of Investment | Asset Type | Amount | % of Portfolio |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| META | Meta Platforms Inc. | Stock | $60,000 | 20% |
| VOO | Vanguard S&P 500 ETF | ETF | $90,000 | 30% |
| KTB | Kontoor Brands, Inc | Stock | $45,000 | 15% |
| 532281 | T-Bond 4.500% 15-May-2038 | Treasury Bond | $90,000 | 30% |
| N/A | Cash | Cash | $15,000 | 5% |
| **Total** | | | **$300,000** | **100%** |

Your table should reflect the composition and allocation of your final WInS portfolio, expressed using the original $300,000 investment. The total must equal $300,000 and 100%. Do not use the ending market value of your WInS portfolio or incorporate WInS gains and losses into Laura's long-term financial projections.

Use your accompanying narrative to evaluate:

- How the portfolio's construction and allocation reflect your strategy
- How diversification and risk considerations influenced your decisions
- The intended roles of the most important holdings or asset classes
- How effectively the portfolio aligns with your IPS and Laura's financial goals

Focus on the holdings and portfolio decisions most important to understanding your strategy. You do not need to explain every individual holding.

### Section 3: Integrated Recommendation and Reflection

**Minimum:** Six pages **Maximum:** Eight pages

Apply the investment strategy established in your IPS, as demonstrated through your final WInS portfolio, to develop an integrated recommendation for Laura. Support your recommendation with reasonable assumptions and analysis.

Your recommendation must:

- Explain how your strategy supports the ten-year operating commitment
- Recommend an appropriate operating reserve
- Recommend a responsible facility contribution while preserving financial flexibility
- Provide a credible dollar range that Laura could communicate to potential co-sponsors in 2031
- Explain the level of confidence associated with that range and the factors that could affect it
- Provide language Laura could use when communicating with prospective co-sponsors

For your long-term analysis, begin with Laura's $300,000 investment at the beginning of 2027 and add the additional $150,000 contribution at the beginning of 2028. Do not add WInS gains or losses to Laura's projected portfolio value.

Clearly identify important assumptions, uncertainties, and limitations. Explain what Laura or her asset management team should monitor as 2031 and 2033 approach and how changing conditions could affect your recommendations.

You are not expected to:

- Estimate the facility's total cost or calculate the complete funding gap
- Prepare a construction budget or detailed business plan
- Account for Laura's personal taxes
- Address the legal or regulatory requirements associated with establishing the residency

**Team Reflection**

Conclude your report by explaining how your team's research, collaboration, disagreements, decision-making, and learning influenced its final recommendation. Focus on the overall competition experience and do not repeat the analysis presented in your Trading Notes Analysis.

## Evaluation Criteria

Evaluators will consider all three deliverables together using five high-level criteria.

**Investment Strategy**

The team establishes and applies a clear and coherent strategy that reflects mid-term and long-term thinking, appropriate diversification, and consistency across the IPS, Trading Notes Analysis, and Final Report.

**Client Knowledge and Objectives**

The team demonstrates a meaningful understanding of Laura's circumstances and financial goals, including the ten-year operating commitment, operating reserve, facility contribution, co-sponsor considerations, liquidity needs, and financial flexibility.

**Portfolio Analysis**
The team uses quantitative and qualitative analysis to evaluate its final WInS portfolio and support its long-term recommendations for Laura. The analysis demonstrates purposeful investment decisions, appropriate allocation and diversification, reasonable assumptions, consideration of uncertainty, and an understanding of the portfolio's strengths and limitations.

WInS gains and losses are not treated as evidence of the quality of the strategy.

**Articulation of Competition Experience**
The team explains how research, collaboration, disagreement, decision-making, uncertainty, and learning shaped its investment thinking and final recommendation.

**Creativity and Presentation**
The team presents a compelling, well-organized, and authentic recommendation. Supporting data, projections, graphics, and co-sponsor communication are used purposefully and effectively.

## Final Standard

Addressing every required element is necessary, but it does not by itself demonstrate strong analysis. The strongest reports will connect the team's established strategy, portfolio decisions, analysis, assumptions, and understanding of Laura's goals into a cohesive and well-supported recommendation.

There is no single correct answer. Your goal is to demonstrate that your team can apply its investment strategy thoughtfully and responsibly to a realistic client scenario.